

**SUNNYSIDE COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
ANNUAL MEETING
Sunday, April 27, 2025**



Location: The Otto Residence 2601 SSRR & on Zoom

Board Members Present:

Rainer Otto, Mark Groskreutz, Renee Groskreutz, Valeri Cardello, RJ Cardello

Quorum was established.

In all, 31 member homes were represented: 10 in-person, 4 confirmed on Zoom (plus one anonymous), and 17 by Proxy. (Proxys submitted by Caine, DeGirolamo, Graner, Hassanally, Kim, Kirk, Koretzky, Kotowski, LaFranchi, Lau/Mashihara, McCallister/Aunt Mona's, Richards, Shannon, Trost, Whyte & Wong).

1. Welcome

Quorum requirements being met, the meeting was called to order at 4:01 pm by HOA President and meeting host Rainer Otto.

2. Minutes of Last Annual Meeting on April 14, 2024

A motion was made, seconded and approved to confirm the Meeting Minutes presented for the prior year's annual meeting.

3. Board Summary of the Prior Year

A summary list of the Board accomplishments was presented, including updated electrical work, installation of a convex traffic mirror, surveillance camera system maintenance and improved wiring, and fully researched septic to sewer conversion project options (determined not feasible and report was emailed to all residents). Held a successful social in August 2024, greeted new residents, and acted as a clearing house to help neighbors communicate with each other (directory, email list, animal issues, Mission Prep reporting, etc). Member and participant in the Counsel of RPV Homeowners Associations (CHOA).

4. Introductions and Homeownership Info

The Secretary provided an overview of our neighborhood: 57 homes share the entrance; 52 are required HOA members per the founding documents; 2 homes rejoined as social members. There are currently 3 homes in transition; one home will be re-rented, and a 2nd will become a new rental as it was purchased with this intent by remote owners. Last year we had 8 homes occupied by residents other than their owners; 1 is an elder care home, 2 are shorter term renters of one year or less, the rest are longer term rentals.

****We welcome all homeowners, residents & tenants on Sunnyside Ridge and Sol Vista Roads to participate in the Sunnyside Community Association meetings and activities, and benefit from our efforts to connect neighbors.****

5. Financial Report & Dues

Treasurer RJ Cardello went over the financial report that was published with the agenda and pre-meeting documents. There is \$8,012.74 in the HOA bank account as of April 1, 2025.

- Expenses have remained flat over the past few years and the 2025/2026 proposed budget was set accordingly: Around \$2,250 for the Entrance Maintenance, \$700 for Annual Meetings and Events, and \$310 for copies and admin.
- Entrance Improvements were lower than last year because only the LAN and power cabling to the surveillance system needed to be replaced.
- Electricity costs were discussed, and the former Treasurer advised that billing became lower and more intermittent once the HOA installed LED lighting.
- This year, the current Treasurer re-wired the electrical boxes on the north side of the street but there is insufficient power load to do anything but run the lights at night on that side of the street (outlet boxes still don't work). The absence of sufficient HOA power (outlets, cable space under the street) have caused some problems for the HOA surveillance system which may need to be addressed in the future; \$500 is estimated for work this coming year.

6. Septic Systems – Maintenance, Care & Replacement

This year's scheduled speaker, Matt Dragitch with family-owned [Peninsula Septic](#), was unable to attend our meeting but hopes to attend next year. Attendees created the following list of questions for next year's meeting: 1) Should we treat our systems with bio treatments or chemicals ourselves? 2) What should be done if you smell a bad odor in your home? 3) How should a septic system 50 years or older be maintained? 4) Explain code compliance questions related to selling a home, or retrofitting a home. 5) Explain gray water systems and segregation of waste streams. 6) How to put in a new or replacement septic system.

In the meantime, experienced residents shared some key information that the HOA would like to circulate to everyone:

- ✓ Personal wipes listed as “flushable” are NEVER, NEVER flushable down any septic system! (These wipes are also harmful to sewer systems & create problems for water treatment as well).
- ✓ It is typically recommended that homeowners have their tanks pumped every 2-3 years. Larger families may want to pump out more frequently.
- ✓ Read the back of your home cleaning products for toilets, bathrooms & kitchens. Are they listed as septic safe? Do they contain bleach or strong chemicals that may harm the “good bacteria” that keep your septic system running well? Choose less harsh cleaning products whenever possible.

7. Neighborhood Crime Report

The HOA President presented data obtained from [Crimemapping.com](#) that allows users to pinpoint their location and obtain data within a specific radius. In the last 4 weeks, there were 37 documented incidents within 2 miles of SSRR: 5 were within one mile.

- While this shows our neighborhood is quite safe, the HOA will continue to support the surveillance system as footage has helped multiple residents this year report on suspicious and criminal activity. Please contact the President or Secretary of the HOA if you need photos or videos of vehicles or pedestrians coming in or out of the street: provide date & time frame.
- A meeting attendee suggested that all neighbors be vigilant when sending personal checks by US Mail. Property tax & related checks mailed from PV and Lomita area post offices have gone missing over the past few years and several postal employees were criminally charged.
- Crime prevention tips continue to be locking mailboxes, locking vehicles, bringing in packages as soon as possible. If you see something or someone suspicious on your property or hanging around on the street, Say Something. Let the Lomita Sheriff's station know right away at their direct phone number: (310) 539-1661.

8. Fire Preparedness

The HOA President presented info on fire preparedness, noting that Sunnyside Ridge is no longer in any Fire Hazard Severity Zone but we all must still maintain [Defensible Space](#) around our structures. Note: we are very close to the Moderate Zone which roughly follows PV Drive East. See the attached slide deck for this map and more detail on what the LACFD requires and what they are doing to help with fire preparedness.

- LA County firefighters will begin their annual inspections in June. If issues are found, you will immediately see a hang-tag on your door telling you what needs to be done and how to request a 2nd inspection. If your home has no issues you will eventually receive a letter by US Mail confirming you are in compliance or you can check [online](#).
- Homeowners are encouraged to check their insurance. Review your home contents valuation, collect documentation such as furniture and home receipts, appraisals, or anything that could help in the event of a fire or loss.
- Another critical suggestion discussed was to NOT do anything that could jeopardize your homeowners insurance. Insurance companies are using any and all excuses to cancel or not renew their policies in California such as missing one payment, using GPS data to claim you have a moldy roof, etc. Once lost, policies are not likely to be reinstated regardless of how long you have been a customer.
- Based on the January wildfires in the LA basin, make sure you have a plan for what to do if our area is impacted suddenly. Pack a Go Bag, connect with authorities, leave early. Sign up for [PV alerts](#) on your cell phone by Texting “alerts” to 888-777.

9. New Mission & Vision Statement of the HOA

The membership reviewed the draft Mission & Vision document drafted by the President to help explain what the HOA’s purpose is. A wording suggestion was made by attendees and the updated document will be circulated after the board reviews a modified version.

The Board’s intention of this document is to help homeowners and residents understand what steps they can personally take to make our neighborhood a more friendly and safe community. The bottom line is that the HOA needs everyone’s participation to reinvigorate and link our residents together, as we notice less “neighborhood spirit” than we ever have before.

10. Election of New Board Members

Mike Sarullo volunteered to be a new Board member. Thank you, Mike!

As no other volunteers came forward, Rainer Otto, Valeri Cardello, RJ Cardello, Mark Groskreutz and Renee Groskreutz agreed to continue their Board service. The Secretary noted that the Board met via Zoom approximately quarterly last year due to the lack of topics that required attention.

A motion was made and there was unanimous approval to accept the Board: Mike Sarullo – new member, Rainer Otto, RJ Cardello, Valeri Cardello, Mark Groskreutz, and Renee Groskreutz.

11. Open Forum

- a) Neighborhood Watch: The HOA would like to thank Sue Spellacy and Bob Laman for their many years of service as our Zone 1 and Zone 2/3 Coordinators, respectively. Recent changes with the Sheriff’s Department have reduced the amount of meaningful crime data and details that the

volunteer who leads up the RPV Neighborhood Watch (NW) organization can circulate, and updates are not as frequent as before.

Overall, there seems to be a lack of direct engagement and interest in HOA and Neighborhood Watch, possibly because residents experience email or communication “overload.” The future of continuing to have NW street coordinators is in question and the Board and coordinators will continue to talk about the best solution.

- b) Additional Social Events: A member requested that the HOA host multiple social events each year, to help give residents more opportunities to connect. If you are interested in helping host or coordinate a second social event, such as an evening holiday party or progressive dinner, please contact Renee Groskreutz or another member of the HOA Board.
- c) Hairpin Curve at Sunnyside Intersection with PV Drive East: A resident brought up the traffic and pedestrian dangers associated with the sharp “S Curve” that exists at the top of our street. It is for this reason that the HOA is continuing to maintain the No Parking Signs, large rocks, and the convex traffic mirror to discourage parking in this area. The Board will look into options to make the curve less sharp.
- d) HOA White Board: The Groskreutz family volunteered to update the HOA Whiteboard sign with messages and seasonal greetings. Due to privacy concerns, we do not use the sign to present contact info or detailed street updates that may be seen by non-residents or potential criminals. If you want to advertise babysitting, free fruit or any help to your neighbors, residents should feel free to slide the Plexiglass around and put up a temporary notice.
- e) Stone Street Header Signs: Residents noticed that the lettering on the stone & metal Sunnyside Ridge street signs is becoming difficult to read, particularly at night. Mike Sarullo offered to help the Board repaint the black metal backing to increase visibility.
- f) Annual Social Event: The current HOA Board is committed to continue holding at least one social event each year. The Groskreutz Family kindly offered to hold another Ice Cream Summer Social in their front yard. Target date is the weekend before PV schools return around mid-August.

BUSINESS CONCLUDED AND MEETING ADJOURNED 5:37 PM

